ADKAR Change Readiness

Find where people are in a change, spot the barrier point, and act on it before moving on.

Lead the Organisation · Inspired by Prosci's ADKAR® Model (Jeff Hiatt) · The People Side of Change

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

CHANGE: Substitutes in stores

SPONSOR: Head of Store Ops

1 Change on a Page

WHAT, WHY, WHO, WHEN

What's changing: pickers choose substitutes for out-of-stock items

Who's affected: pickers in 12 stores, store managers, customer service

Why now: fewer second orders, and customers have asked for it

Key dates: pilot in one store from 2 June; all stores in July

2 Readiness Grid

SCORE 1-5 · THE FIRST LOW SCORE IS THE BARRIER POINT

PERSON OR GROUP	A · AWARENESS	D · DESIRE	K · KNOWLEDGE	A · ABILITY	R · REINFORCEMENT	BARRIER POINT
Pickers, pilot store	1 2 3 **4** 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	**1** 2 3 4 5	**1** 2 3 4 5	Desire
Store managers	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 2 3 **4** 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	Knowledge
Customer service	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	**1** 2 3 4 5	Awareness
Basket team	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 2 3 **4** 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	Ability
Store Ops lead	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 **2** 3 4 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	Desire

Circle each score. Scores run 1 (not at all) to 5 (fully). The barrier point is the first element scored 3 or lower, working left to right. Fix it before working on later elements.

A · Awareness — of why the change is needed

MISSING IF…

People ask "why are we doing this?"
Rumours fill the silence

WHAT HELPS

- Sponsor explains the why, early and often
- Share the cost of not changing

Our action: Priya explains the why at huddles

D · Desire — to support and take part

MISSING IF…

People understand, but resist or stall
"What's in it for me?" is unanswered

WHAT HELPS

- Involve people in shaping the change
- Managers discuss concerns one-to-one

Our action: pickers help design the screen

K · Knowledge — of how to change

MISSING IF…

Willing, but unsure what to do
Lots of "how do I…?" questions

WHAT HELPS

- Training, guides and worked examples
- Show the new way on real work

Our action: a one-page guide with examples

A · Ability — to do it in practice

MISSING IF…

Know how, but can't do it yet
Old habits return under pressure

WHAT HELPS

- Coaching, pairing and practice time
- Remove blockers: tools, time, access

Our action: practice runs before the pilot

R · Reinforcement — to make it stick

MISSING IF…

Early wins, then people slide back
The old way is still rewarded

WHAT HELPS

- Recognise and celebrate adoption
- Measure use; fix what pulls people back

Our action: share wins weekly with managers

3 Action Plan

ONE ACTION PER BARRIER POINT

WHO (PERSON OR GROUP)	BARRIER POINT	ACTION	OWNER	BY WHEN
Customer service	Awareness	a briefing on why, and what customers will see	Priya	23 May
Pickers, pilot store	Desire	two pickers co-design the substitute screen	Mei	30 May

4 Reinforce & Re-assess

We'll recognise success by: pickers suggest swaps without asking

We'll measure adoption by: % of missing items with a substitute

Re-assess on: 4 weeks into the pilot

"Where is each group in this change, really?"

"What's the first thing stopping them, and what would help most?"

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